

Experiment No.:- 10

Objective:- To implement N-Queens problem.

Theory

The **N-Queens Problem** is a classic problem in computer science.

- You are given:

- o An $N \times N$ **chessboard**

- o **N queens**

- Goal:

Place all N queens on the board such that:

- No two queens attack each other

Conditions:

- No two queens share the same row

- No two queens share the same column

- No two queens share the same diagonal

Approach: Backtracking

We place queens row by row and check if placing a queen is safe.

Safety Check Conditions:

- No queen in same column

- No queen in left diagonal

- No queen in right diagonal

If safe → place queen

Else → try next column

Algorithm

1. Start
2. Input value of N
3. Initialize an empty chessboard
4. Place queens row by row using recursion
5. For each column:
 - o Check if position is safe
 - o If safe → place queen
 - o Recur for next row
 - o If fails → backtrack (remove queen)
6. If all queens placed → print solution
7. Stop.

Program:

```
#include <stdio.h>
```

```
#define MAX 20
```

```
int board[MAX];

// Function to check if queen can be placed
int isSafe(int row, int col) {
    for (int i = 0; i < row; i++) {
        // Same column or diagonal
        if (board[i] == col ||
            board[i] - i == col - row ||
            board[i] + i == col + row) {
            return 0;
        }
    }
    return 1;
}

// Function to solve N-Queens using backtracking
void solveNQueens(int row, int n) {
    if (row == n) {
        printf("\nSolution:\n");
        for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
            for (int j = 0; j < n; j++) {
                if (board[i] == j)
                    printf(" Q ");
                else
                    printf(" . ");
            }
            printf("\n");
        }
        return;
    }

    for (int col = 0; col < n; col++) {
        if (isSafe(row, col)) {
            board[row] = col; // place queen
            solveNQueens(row + 1, n);
        }
    }
}

int main() {
    int n;

    printf("Enter number of queens: ");
```

```
scanf("%d", &n);  
  
solveNQueens(0, n);  
  
return 0;  
}
```

Example Input

Enter number of queens: 4

Example Output

Solution:

```
. Q . .  
. . . Q  
Q . . .  
. . Q .
```

Time Complexity

- Worst case: $O(N!)$

(Backtracking explores all possible configurations)

Result

The N-Queens problem was successfully implemented using **Backtracking**. The algorithm efficiently finds all possible ways to place N queens on the chessboard such that no two queens attack each other.